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drink and dubbed it ‘the martini’ after the bartender. The Knickerbocker continues to use the original recipe which had gin and not vodka. As per them, it is two ounces of gin, three-fourths ounce of dry vermouth, half ounce of sweet vermouth, a dash of orange bitters, a dash of citrus bitters, and lemon peel, for garnish.

The martini that Bond prefers is actually a Vesper, named after Vesper Lynd, the original Bond girl, and probably the only woman he loved. It is a combination of gin and vodka. The cocktail featured in Ian Fleming’s very first Bond novel—*Casino Royale*. In the book, Bond himself tells the exact recipe to the bartender. “A dry martini. One. In a deep champagne goblet. . . . Three measures of Gordon’s, one of vodka, half a measure of Kina Lillet. Shake it very well until it’s ice-cold, then add a large thin slice of lemon peel. Got it?” Kina Lillet is a fortified wine.

Many of today’s most popular

cocktails have histories that span the globe and have interesting back stories. Take the negroni, for example. Named after Florentine Count Camillo Negroni, the drink was invented in 1919. In the book *Negroni Cocktail: An Italian Legend*, author Luca Picchi says that Count Negroni spent a lot of time in New York City where he frequented cocktail bars. On his return to Florence he noticed that the only famous concoction in Italian high society was a simple mixture made with red vermouth, a splash of bitter Campari and soda. It was called Americano as it was popular with American tourists. Negroni suggested the bartender use less soda and add gin, and the Negroni cocktail was born.

“Unlike other cocktails that are sweet and sour, a negroni is a bitter and sweet cocktail. It is the simplest to make as the ratio is 1: 1: 1 between the gin, the vermouth and the Campari,” says Yangdup Lama,

Co-founder of Delhi-based Sidecar, the only Indian bar to make it to the World’s 50 Best Bars 2022 list.

Lama mentions the mojito as another popular cocktail enjoyed by a large number of people. This minty, refreshing drink—a combination of white rum, sugar, lime juice, soda and mint—started life as a cure for scurvy. “Due to different cocktail cultures all around, there are different romanticised versions of how the mojito, or any cocktail for that matter, came to be,” says Jonas Ax, Advocacy Lead, Bacardi. “The consensus on the mojito and its history that most bartenders choose to believe, is that the drink came about when the Europeans reached the area around Cuba and Puerto Rico. They began suffering from tropical illnesses. While they were ashore they gathered ingredients that would aid them in tackling tropical illnesses, according to local South American Indians. What they brought with them was something